

Felipe Vaz Peres

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EXPERIENCE

Huna

Data Scientist

Remote

Sep 2025 - Present

- Develop interpretable risk-stratification models for early cancer detection, prioritizing coefficient-level transparency and clinical auditability
- Co-authored an ASCO 2026 abstract on prostate cancer risk stratification in 2,978 men across seven Brazilian diagnostic networks, achieving 0.77 AUC and 35.1% fewer false positives versus PSA ≥ 4 ng/mL

Center for Microbial Secondary Metabolites, Technical University of Denmark

Guest Researcher

Remote

Jan 2024 - Jan 2025

- Developed an end-to-end long-read metagenomics pipeline for 100+ marine samples, generating 40 high-quality microbial genomes (>90% completeness)
- Applied ML-based contig classification to distinguish prokaryotic and eukaryotic sequences, enabling genome reconstruction from complex microbial communities
- Standardized biosynthetic gene cluster annotation across 40 genomes, cataloging 148 full-length BGCs
- Automated analysis and benchmarking workflows, reducing manual execution and improving reproducibility

Computational, Evolutionary and Systems Biology Laboratory, University of São Paulo

Graduate Researcher

Piracicaba, SP

Jan 2022 - Jan 2025

- Applied ML models (SVM, Random Forest, CNN) for large-scale ncRNA identification across 48 sugarcane genotypes, identifying 8.4M candidate ncRNAs
- Built and analyzed co-expression networks containing 1M+ nodes, identifying 7,000+ ncRNA-protein modules, revealing functional roles across diverse genetic backgrounds
- Functionally annotated 250K+ ncRNAs establishing a framework for investigating biological functions in this complex polyploid crop
- Contributed to 5 open-source projects across bacteria, microalgae, and plants, building automated Nextflow pipelines used by 3 research groups

Genera

Bioinformatics Intern

Remote

Jan 2020 - Mar 2020

- Improved a human ancestry classification pipeline analyzing 650K+ SNPs across 72 population groups, including underrepresented South American populations
- Developed technical documentation for the ancestry inference workflow

Computational, Evolutionary and Systems Biology Laboratory, University of São Paulo

Undergraduate Researcher

Piracicaba, SP

May 2019 - May 2021

- Processed 3.7B sequencing reads (>1.1 TB) on HPC infrastructure to construct a sugarcane pan-transcriptome spanning 48 genotypes and 16M transcripts
- Developed an automated Snakemake pipeline for transcriptome assembly and comparative analysis of 600K+ protein variants
- Presented reproducible workflow design at ISMB, demonstrating scalability across polyploid crop species

EDUCATION

University of São Paulo, Center of Nuclear Energy in Agriculture

M.Sc. in Bioinformatics

Piracicaba, SP

Jan 2025

- Relevant coursework: Genomics, Bioinformatics

Federal University of São Carlos, Center of Agrarian Sciences

B.S. in Biotechnology

Araras, SP

Jan 2022

- Relevant coursework: Statistics, Bioinformatics, Molecular Biology, Genetic Engineering

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Bash, R

Machine Learning: scikit-learn, statistical modeling, model validation, interpretable ML, MLflow

Data & Infrastructure: Databricks, GCP, Unix/Linux, HPC (SGE, PBS, LSF, SLURM), git

Computational Biology: genomics, metagenomics, transcriptomics, NGS (short and long reads), gene expression, co-expression networks, functional annotation

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **3rd place:** Liga Brasileira de Bioinformática - The largest bioinformatics competition in Latin America *Jun 2025*
- **Graduate Research Fellowship:** National Council for Scientific and Technological Development (CNPq) *April 2022*
- **3rd place:** Developed an automated variant calling pipeline in under 48 hours at *Mendelics Challenge* *Nov 2021*
- **Honorable mention:** International Symposium of Undergraduate Research at University of São Paulo *Oct 2020*
- **Undergraduate Research Fellowship:** São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP) *April 2019*
- **2nd place:** Synthetic Biology Hackathon at University of São Carlos *Aug 2018*

SOFTWARE

Additional work can be seen on my GitHub profile: <https://github.com/felipevzps>

Selected work

- [KAPT](#), [R2C](#): Nextflow pipelines for proteome inference and co-expression network construction, in active use by external research groups
- [seabed-symphony](#) - Pipeline for BGCs identification in microbial community of marine sediments

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2022 Python: From zero to your first software

Presented at workshop - Python Workshop for Biological Data, Online Conference - UNICAMP

An introduction to programming for bioscientists

Presented at workshop - Genetics and Molecular Biology Meeting, Online Conference - UNICAMP

2021 Removing reads from contaminating organisms in NGS datasets

Poster - Brazilian Symposium on Bioinformatics, Online Conference - Federal University of Minas Gerais

2020 Analysis of *de novo* transcriptome assemblies in sugarcane

Selected Talk (Top 15%) - International Symposium of Undergraduate Research, University of São Paulo